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Samarkand Is Lost to Shaybāni (AD 1501)

Shaybāni Khān's siege had prolonged. This also extended the unavailability of provisions and supplies in all quarters. There was no succour and reinforcement from any side. Both soldiers as well as the common men and peasants had begun to become hopeless. They began to flee one by one, by crossing the walls.

The news of distressed townsfolk reached Shaybāni Khān. This is exactly what he had been waiting for quite some time. Certainly, his besieging of the fort had paid off. He came riding and dismounted near the Lovers' Cave. Full of fear, Babur ran to Malik-Muhammad Mīrzā's house in the low lane.

At the same time appeared the old devil (as Babur has mentioned in the *Baburnama*). Khwaja Husain's brother Aūzūn Hasan came into the town with more than two dozen men. He had been the cause behind Jahāngīr Mīrzā's rebellion that led to Babur's exodus from Samarkand in March of AD 1498 and his appearance seemed no less than a bold and embellished act of treachery to Babur.[1]

Civilians and the soldiers had grown more and more distressed. The men whom Babur had trusted the most had begun to get down the ramparts. Those trusted men included known begs and old family servants such as Pīr Wais, Shaikh Wais and Wais Lāgharī. Babur was in complete despair and saw no ray of hope. Their supplies and provisions were completely wretched and what was there in stock was nearing end.

Then came a ray of hope, which certainly was not the kind Babur would have liked. Shaybāni Khān proposed peace talks. Given that he was besieged for a long time, Babur was left with no other choice but to agree. He has mentioned in the *Baburnama* that he would have given less ear to the truce talks if there had been any hope or food from any side.